



What use is knowledge that makes nothing?



Class video: <https://youtu.be/4ujRRTinCR0>

The code leads to the video.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Before you start

1. A machine answers almost anything for you in two seconds. So what is the use of a kind of knowledge that makes nothing? Answer in one sentence.
2. **At the end of the class.** Reread your answer. Would you change it? If you do, what reason made you change? If not, what objection could you answer?

While you watch the video

1. According to a story Plato records, a servant girl mocked Thales when he fell into a well while looking at the stars. Was the servant girl right? Why?

2. What does the word "philosophy" mean?

3. **Your prediction.** In winter, Thales foresees a great olive harvest, and he has little money. How would you use it to get rich?

4. **How do we know?** The two stories about Thales, the well and the olive presses: who tells each one, when, and what for?

5. Can the chain of what-fors go on forever? Why?

Your chain of what-fors

Starting point:

→ And that, what for?

→ And that, what for?

→ And that, what for?

→ And that, what for?

The four features

1. What did we do in the class that was critical?

2. And radical?

3. And rational?

4. And comprehensive?

Practice

1. Make your own chain of what-fors, starting from something you do every day, until you reach something that is worth something in itself.
2. Look outside this class, in a news story or a conversation, for an example of each feature of philosophy.
3. What's the difference between having an opinion and defending a position?
4. Find a famous saying attributed to a philosopher, one of those going around the internet, and find out whether they really said it, and where.

Keep thinking

This class was written by an artificial intelligence and reviewed by a person. Can a machine philosophise, or only answer? And how would we know?